

Call for Expressions of Interest

<i>Date of Issue:</i>	September 2026
<i>Expected Completion Date:</i>	May 2027
<i>Project Title:</i>	Visualising visitor data
<i>Company:</i>	Manuscripts and Special Collections
Contact Details	
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Additional Info	
<i>Students must sign NDA:</i>	☒
<i>Project uses personal data:</i>	☒
<i>Custom hardware required:</i>	☐ If Applicable: Please provide details
<i>Relevant research areas (if applicable)¹:</i>	AI, communication, user experience
Project Background Information	
Manuscripts and Special Collections (MSC) runs a reading room which is accessed by researchers from all around the world to view the University of Nottingham's collections of archives and rare books. Statistics relating to readers and the material consulted are manually collected by staff and are used to prepare quarterly key performance indicators (KPIs), to assess the usage of different collections over time, and for reports to national bodies such as the Archives and Records Association (required part of professional accreditation) and the SCONUL Access Scheme (a professional association for academic and research libraries in the UK and Ireland). Data is collected over multiple Excel spreadsheets with varying structures and formatting, making interrogation of the overall data more complicated.	

¹ An overview of different research areas in the school of computer science can be found [here](#).

Requirements	
<i>The group must provide:</i> Staff at MSC believe that more could be done with the data to enable them to generate more holistic overviews of user data, identify trends, and to help develop strategies in terms of targeting specific University departments or to promote underused collections. Manuscripts and Special Collections would love a tool or app to be developed which would help them interrogate their data and present it in an engaging and visual way as well as meeting the reporting requirements of the University and national bodies.	
Skills	
<i>Highly desirable:</i> Experience or interest in visual communication Experience or interest in interrogating usage data Experience or interest in app development	<i>Desirable:</i>
Submission / Award information	
<i>Date of Submission:</i>	September 2026
<i>Date of Pitch:</i>	October 2026
<i>Notification of award:</i>	October 2026

For further information on this proposal, the team representative should in the first instance e-mail the lead contact stated above at the e-mail address provided.